

A Fine Balance: Exploring the Interplay of Reproductive Strategies and Growth Dynamics in Trees

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You might have noticed the phenomenon when trees in an area bear tons of fruits all together in certain years but not every year, and wonder what happened to them. Well, this is a common reproductive strategy called masting. One hypothesis is a growth-reproduction trade-off: trees put resources into growth some years, and into seeds in others, often tied to climate. For my project, I am using long-term pair data on tree growth and seed production for tree species exhibiting strong masting patterns collected at different elevations to test this hypothesis. This is very much a work in progress, and I'd love feedback on the model. If you are interested in seeing how stan gets used in forest ecology. Come find my poster!